



BREAKING POINT

Suit of Crescents

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What is this?

Breaking Point: Suit of Crescents features nine changes a **Broken** player-character could experience, all of which are based on the KULT Tarot. As the Gamemaster, you are invited to change and adapt them to better fit your story, as well as attach any other effects relevant to what caused the PC to break. Other suits will be released in the near future.



Characters, locations and incidents are portrayed from the metaphorical viewpoint of the *KULT: Divinity Lost* setting.



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VISIONS AND NEEDS

How long does “Brokenness” last? What are its consequences? How will the PCs change? Is this forgettable and/or treatable? The truth of the matter is that these and many more questions have answers unique to each game. It all depends on context, GMing style, campaign themes, the Horror Contract, etcetera.

A splatterpunk themed game might have the player-characters peak momentary madness and frenzy, while a story about altered conscience might require that they remain *Broken* for long periods of time. One is sudden, chaotic, and hyper-violent. The other is calm and surreal. Some groups will gladly delve into the depths of the human mind to explore philosophical questions. Others want nothing but Hollywoodian meltdowns. Maybe you want to experience *Broken* for the sheer power it brings (Enlightenment through Madness), or maybe you’re seeking the discussions about mental health that it sparks (*Broken* as a mental illness). Either way, it is up to each group to define what it looks like in their own campaign.

With that said, here are some questions to help you shape what *Broken* means and looks like. If breaking is meant to be a big part of your story, consider using these questions to expand the Horror Contract before the game begins. This is not a definitive list, so remember to expand on the answers and allow more questions to emerge as needed.

- ◆ What are the main themes of the campaign? How could a *Broken* PC enhance them?
- ◆ How is *Brokenness* experienced under these themes? And for how long?
- ◆ Are there any lingering effects?
- ◆ Is it possible to ever be normal again after breaking?
- ◆ Which additional systems would benefit the story? Maybe additional Player Moves, maybe bonuses or penalties to Attributes, or perhaps none are needed.
- ◆ Which “glimpses of the Truth” could be experienced?
- ◆ Does the Horror Contract limit an aspect of being *Broken*? If so, which aspects and how?

+TAROT+ICA

This release presents ideas based on the Suit of Crescents. These are not the only effects of these cards. Rather, see them as a starting point to develop your own vision. You are of course invited to grab the Tarot Guide (available for free on our website) and brainstorm while reading this document.

Each idea is followed by a suggestion of a new Advantage and Disadvantage the PCs might have access to while *Broken*. It is up to you to determine if they should retain these Moves after “unbreaking”. As a rule of thumb, if you wish to avoid dealing with too many Advantages, it’s wise to ask the Player to erase one of her own before gaining access to the new one. Alternatively, if the player-characters are supposed to remain *Broken* for a short period of time and won’t change dramatically after that, you may want to avoid erasing any Moves. Instead, you could simply keep them locked until the “benefits” of being *Broken* have disappeared. The same applies to Disadvantages.

These changes may or may not happen in conjunction with the GM Moves suggested in the corebook. As per the corebook writing, you don’t have to hand new Advantages to the characters, but it does help to better illustrate what it feels like to Break.

Known Homebrew

Some GMs like to simply activate Disadvantages as if the Player rolled -9 whenever needed. Others, not so much. Some don’t think *Broken* characters are capable of *Keeping it Together*... and, again, others disagree. Truly, *Broken* is a plot device for you to explore KULT’s cosmology more deeply and without restraints. However, if you’d rather have some sort of system to guide you, a widely used homebrew is to maintain the mechanics of Critical Stress whilst *Broken* (penalties to *Keep it Together* and Disadvantage rolls and bonus to *See Through the Illusion*). If these modifiers fit your vision and needs, it would be wise to keep them.

CRESCENTS

Also known as the Moon, the Crescent is a symbol of the dream, the search for the unattainable, and the source of creation. The dream inspires and strengthens, but is also a crutch for the unbearable in life and an escape from reality. It has a strong connection to Limbo.

1. Vortex

The influence of the Vortex leaks through the cracks in the character's fractured mindscape. For as long as the character remains *Broken*, she will be a catalyst of the Dream. Her inner universe, wholly distorted by the chaotic touch of the Vortex, will continue to affect changes in reality. Reality splits open to reveal bridges from Elysium into Limbo and distorted, half-formed Dream beings crawl out. A dark corner becomes a gateway into dreams of darkness, doors appear where none should be, people become featureless as otherworldly pests poke through their skin and burst forth from the holes in their head. Objects no longer stay fixed—they change in appearance, location, and gain undecipherable magical properties.

Advantage: *Contagious Insanity* (KDL, p. 113).

Disadvantage: *Condemned* (KDL, p. 97) to represent the character being consumed by the Vortex, or *Schizophrenia* (KDL, p. 101) but Holds can be spent to turn hallucinations into reality.

2. Creation

The character is overtaken by a powerful surge of emotion. She feels it boiling inside her chest, flowing through her veins and adding pressure to her head. Her body begins to frail and wither as every ounce of energy is turned inwards to bring together multiple tattered dream worlds under her rule. Soon, her nose and ears begin to leak blood and she witnesses reality warping to reflect her innermost desires and fears, all merged seamlessly by her subconscious. At once, her slumbering divinity flares. To others, she's rolling her eyes up, perhaps with a wicked smile peeking through the blood. To her, the landscape is torn and she can see both her new kingdom and the waking world, at will.

While *Broken*, the Illusion around her weakens, bringing her surroundings into the borderlands of her dream. The unwary caught in this web of madness might physically slip into Limbo never to come back, but perceptive souls realize what's happening. The character's dream self may be glimpsed when others see through the Illusion. Until she snaps out of it, she cannot wander out of these borderlands. She is effectively trapped in locations where the Illusion is weak.

Advantage: *Dreamer* (KDL, p. 114), *Enhanced Awareness* (KDL, p. 114), or *The Art of Dreaming* (KULT Drop #18).

Disadvantage: *Involuntary Medium* (KDL, p. 98). Dream beings from her world could possess her and act in Elysium by using her body.

3. Undoing

The character's *Broken* soul ravages her mind, perhaps as a desperate attempt to break free from the confines of human existence. She physically feels memories being torn through powerful visions that affect reality. She could suddenly remember that one joyful picnic with her deceased father, but in this new

image she lunges at him with a knife. Her first kiss turns disgusting as the lover is reframed as a cadaver. That one night out she got wasted and met that one special friend turns violent, as the scene turns into multiple people ganging up on her to leave her disfigured. She jolts awake from a nightmare where recent past events are played out differently in traumatizing forms. And so on. Reflexively, she lets go of these memories—even the spoiled, reframed ones—as the marks left by those leave visible wounds and bruises.

The longer this goes on, the less memories she's able to hold on to. And the closer she gets to becoming unfettered to the Principles that influenced her through these cherished and terrifying experiences. But what happens when the Principles lose hold over her?

Moves: You could handle this through GM Moves or perhaps *Repressed Memories* (KDL, p. 100) where she gets glimpses of the memories that have been changed by the forces within her.

4. Transformation

The character shifts into Limbo, abandoning her physical shell. She could have fallen into a coma, or perhaps she died. The experience could be seamless. Maybe she doesn't even see a difference for the first few moments and continues to live through the memories she holds on. The memory of a commute. The memory of working. Relaxing somewhere she finds safe. The inconsistencies will unravel slowly as the memories come close to other dream worlds and frail—the commute never ends or the streets are different, the tasks at work are meaningless and the papers are full of gibberish or colleagues vanish without a trace, and so on.

Or it might be a sublime but terrifying experience. She could feel weightless and see her visage become warped to reflect what she feels and thinks. Think of a friend who could her, she now has his tattoos on her arm. Think of a gun to take her own life, she now bleeds and has a gaping gunshot wound in her head. Think she might be dead already, and she now has the semblance of a bloating corpse. Perhaps when she gains awareness of this, she also realizes power flowing through her. Limited only by her own imagination.

Advantage: *Dreamer* (KDL, p. 114), or *The Art of Dreaming* (KULT Drop #18).

Disadvantage: *Object of Desire* (KDL, p. 100). Dream beings mimicking human life flock to her dreams. They want to have what she has. They want to feel her, be her.

5. Connection

The character is connected to the dream world of a known Dream Prince who now extends their reach into the waking world through her. Under the Prince's shadow, and by rule of Similarity, she gravitates towards what resonates with the dream world. She has a difficult time being in locations where

the Illusion is strong unless these also ring true to the dream world's themes and concepts. She could be recognized as a potent vessel of the dream and be deemed an important resource that must be protected. For example, the Prince could be weakened and having her dream of his world rejuvenates the landscape, fills him with power, or perhaps keeps the Vortex from swallowing it whole. Or she could be seen as a threat—someone who's stealing power from his kingdom in Limbo by dreaming it herself.

Regardless of what happens, this connection relies on the fragility of her mind. It is when she is most weak that the Prince can affect the waking world—see into it, dispatch Watchers, or come in contact with her. Regaining **Stability** could mean that the connection is severed, but she could also stop dreaming or lose any help or power from a pact sealed with the entity.

Advantage: **Watchers** (KDL, p. 120).

Disadvantage: **Haunted** (KDL, p. 98).

6. Merging

In the throes of insanity, the character's subconscious draws others' minds, memories, and dreams, to orbit hers. These crash violently in a metaphysical dance that may be experienced fully only when dreaming or as one's perception of reality is altered by drugs. With each crash, names and faces are forgotten or rewritten, memories come together to form new ones consisting of details from both of them, and personalities are welded tight. Soon, these people dream the same dreams and believe to have a shared past when in truth they have not. But is it possible for the bodies to merge as well?

Moves: Consider asking characters to exchange Attribute values, Advantages, Disadvantages, and Relations between each other. Or, making changes to the character sheet that reflect the abilities and Relations the "merging NPCs" have.

7. Reflection

The character's reflection has a life of its own. It moves freely within the confines of what's reflected in the mirror, possibly splitting into multiple different personas when seen through a cracked surface. These could represent different aspects of the character's personality—conflicting voices, desires, fears, ideas, and needs. Or these could be Dream beings reaching out from the depths of her psyche to manipulate the character, drain her energy, or perhaps just continue eroding her sanity. Attacking her. Maybe at the borderlands of madness she will finally become a proper vessel for them.

Advantage: **Inner Power** (KDL, p. 115) to represent the beings. Perhaps what they do within the reflection happens in the real world as well, but the Illusion adjusts any recordings and memories to paint the character as the perpetrator of any violent crimes.

Disadvantage: **Haunted** (KDL, p. 98).

8. Repetition

The event that made the character break repeats itself. This could happen in the waking world due to the character shifting in Time and Space. Or it could be that the character relives the same moments that lead to her breaking point through dreams or nightmares, daydreams, and visions. Others reenact tidbits of what went down, such as a phrase that keeps coming up, or a random sound that is provoke every now and then. When she dreams, she is there again. Reliving the event in full force, as lucid as it can possibly be. But every time the scenery changes a little—the color of the wall, the words she or someone else speaks, and so on until it becomes so eroded that it doesn't feel like the same scene even though it does feel like it. In truth, this might be the character's purgatory taking shape, the dream is being assimilated into the realm of a powerful Dream Prince, or perhaps that a Dream being is lodged in her mind (or birthed by her insanity) and now is feeding on her energy—growing, changing.

Advantage: **Jaded** (KDL, p. 120).

Disadvantage: **Mental Compulsion** (KDL, p. 99). Something she does to avoid triggering the memories.

9. Stillness

The mind shuts down. The character's internal destruction rages on but it is silent. While *Broken*, she won't feel pain or shock. She trudges onwards into unspeakable terrors with a chilling, expressionless face. Within her, these emotions are powerful tides that keep throwing boundless waves around and what cannot materialize in the waking world as crying, screaming, and the like, instead withers her body. Hair loss, bloody coughs, pale skin.

Yet, and perhaps ironically so, the Illusion strengthens around her. Ephemeral creatures notice her walking through the veil, leaving her mark in the spiritual fabric dividing both realities, but to the character their screams remains a muffled sound in the back of her mind. Emotionless, she sees the tapestry of the Illusion reweave a monster's appearance into that of a battered human, gateways to other worlds vanishing, and the Children of the Night cowering into the darkness to evade her presence.

Advantage: **Gritted Teeth** (KDL, p. 119).

Disadvantage: **Rationalist** (KDL, p. 100). Or perhaps the character could be **Condemned** (KDL, p. 97) to become a Sleeper again.

